

A Matter of Recession



"You seem a bit lost. Is this the first time you have visited our firm?"

"Yes, sir. I..."

"It is an amazing place. We started out from a room in a hostel a couple of years ago and today we are a million-dollar organisation...and still growing. In all directions!"

"Yes, sir. I was..."

"Looking around? Yes, do so by all means. You can also visit the demo labs and try out some of the products we have come out with in recent times. As well as some of the old ones, actually -- though there are some OS compatibility issues. You could try out some of our "crash, burn and die in seven minutes" betas too. They are a new concept in demos—if you use them for too long, they format your hard drive and set fire to your keyboard!"

"Well, I was looking for..."

"We have tie-ups with some of the biggest firms in the business. We operate in six countries and offer round-the-clock support for all our products, 60 seconds a minute, 60 minutes an hour, 24 hours a day, seven days, two weeks a fortnight, two fortnights a month, twelve months a year and ten years a decade. After that we will see! And we are proactive too—when our customers did not upgrade their products, we encouraged them to do so by telling them that their existing copies would expire in two days, unless upgraded."

"Yes, I do know that. The famous "Upgrade or crash. Karo ya maro" campaign, wasn't it? I..."

"So glad you have seen the campaign. It got us so much visibility. Some people were annoyed at having to shell out extra cash for the upgrade, but then, we cannot let costs come in the way of progress, can we?"

"It was very innovative..."

"Well, one of the reasons for success has been the fact that we have been able to offer solutions that are low-cost in comparison to their counterparts. We like to stay one step ahead of the competition—sometimes even two steps. To innovate constantly, we breed a culture of innovation. From the CEO who uses three different phones to write one SMS; to the newspaper boy who is encouraged to wrap the newspapers in new shapes every day; to the CEO's driver who finds new ways to park his car in the parking spaces of other companies; to ..."

"Actually, sir, what I was looking for..."

"A lot of people have been saying that the current recession is bad for business. Nonsense, I say. It is in fact a tremendous opportunity for us. As people are looking to cut costs, we can come up with more economical solutions. We have even come out with a Pink Slipper—a device that can be used as footwear and also to generate dismissal letters by using a slide out QWERTY keypad that can be activated by moving both straps seventeen degrees to the right."

"The recession..."

"A great opportunity for all innovators. We can redefine businesses, focus on core competencies, and best of all, get access to talent at reasonable costs..."

"Sir, that is what I wanted to talk about."

"You are an HR consultant and want to show us your database of potential employees?"

"No, sir. I..."

"Ah, then you wish to invest in our company as our share prices have declined a bit. An excellent idea! I know our prices have dipped and that we currently have to pay you to buy our shares but that will change. In our world, change is the only constant. Let me forward you to..."

"No, sir. I am applying for a job. Our company is slashing jobs because of the recession..."

"They are? Do you know if they are using Pink Slipper?"

"Sir, please, I just want to submit my resume..."

"Well, you can, my dear chap, but we are not hiring at the moment. The recession, you know..."

"But, sir, you were just talking about how the recession was a great opportunity..."

"So it is. Right now, it is giving us the opportunity to turn down your application. All the very best. Do visit us again." 

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